

Moore, Russell and Early Wittgenstein — MCQ Solutions

Option-specific explanations and examiner traps

Open only after attempting the corresponding question. Every solution explains all four options, identifies the examiner trap, gives a repair action, maps coverage and links the relevant PYQ demand.

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MCQ 1

The analytic revolt represented by Moore, Russell and the early Wittgenstein is most accurately described as:

A. a shared rejection of all metaphysics in favour of experimental psychology alone. B. a revolt against idealist system-building through three distinct uses of analysis C. a single doctrine that identifies common sense with logical atomism D. a defence of British Idealism through more exact grammatical distinctions

Answer: B.

Option explanations: - **A:** Experimental psychology is not their common programme, and each retains philosophical commitments beyond experiment. - **B:** Correct: the shared revolt uses analysis, but Moore protects ordinary knowledge, Russell reveals logical form, and Wittgenstein marks limits. - **C:** Common sense is Moore's method, whereas logical atomism belongs to Russell and, differently, the early Wittgenstein. - **D:** They oppose rather than defend the Bradleyan-Hegelian system that formed their immediate background.

Examiner trap 1: Flattening three programmes into one doctrine.

Repair action: State one distinct question and method for each thinker.

Coverage mapping: C01.

PYQ linkage: All; attribution control.

MCQ 2

Which attribution is exact?

A. Moore—verification; Russell—family resemblance; Wittgenstein—common-sense certainty as their defining methods B. Moore—defence of common sense; Russell—incomplete symbols; early Wittgenstein—saying/showing C. Moore—logical constructions; Russell—diaphanous consciousness; Wittgenstein—ordinary names D. Moore—negative facts; Russell—hinge propositions; Wittgenstein—proof by two hands

Answer: B.

Option explanations: - **A:** Verification belongs to Logical Positivism, family resemblance to later Wittgenstein, and truisms to Moore. - **B:** Correct: these are the printed syllabus owners and their characteristic doctrines. - **C:** Logical constructions are Russell's, diaphanous consciousness is Moore's, and ordinary-name analysis is Russell's. - **D:** Negative facts are Russell's; hinge propositions are later Wittgenstein's; the hands proof is Moore's.

Examiner trap 2: Choosing by one familiar name while missing two misattributions.

Repair action: Use the owner table before recalling details.

Coverage mapping: C01.

PYQ linkage: All; ownership.

MCQ 3

Which chronology is correct?

A. Moore's 1903 refutation; Russell's 1905 descriptions; Russell's 1918 lectures; *Tractatus* 1921/22; Moore's 1925 defence and 1939 proof
B. Russell's 1918 lectures; Moore's 1903 refutation; *Tractatus* 1921/22; Russell's 1905 descriptions; Moore's 1939 proof
C. Moore's 1925 defence; Russell's 1905 descriptions; Moore's 1903 refutation; *Tractatus* 1921/22; Russell's 1918 lectures
D. *Tractatus* 1921/22; Russell's 1905 descriptions; Moore's 1939 proof; Moore's 1903 refutation; Russell's 1918 lectures

Answer: A.

Option explanations: - **A:** Correct: the sequence preserves the key publication dates and keeps Moore's defence distinct from his later proof. - **B:** This places 1918 before 1903 and 1905, reversing the actual emergence of the analytic revolt. - **C:** This starts with 1925 and places Moore's 1903 paper after Russell's 1905 paper. - **D:** This begins with the *Tractatus* and badly scrambles the earlier Moore and Russell texts.

Examiner trap 3: Merging Moore's 1925 and 1939 papers or misdating the *Tractatus*.

Repair action: Memorise 1903–1905–1918–1921/22–1925–1939.

Coverage mapping: C01.

PYQ linkage: Provenance across all answers.

MCQ 4

Moore's distinction between knowing and analysing permits him to claim that:

A. ordinary propositions remain uncertain until philosophers complete a final conceptual analysis of them
B. a proposition may be known with certainty even when its correct analysis remains disputed
C. correct analysis changes the truth-value of the proposition being analysed
D. common-sense knowledge is merely shorthand for majority agreement

Answer: B.

Option explanations: - **A:** Moore reverses this priority: knowledge of a truism need not await philosophical analysis. - **B:** Correct: failure to analyse 'body' or 'external object' does not cancel knowledge that one has a body. - **C:** Analysis clarifies content; it does not alter the truth-value of the proposition. - **D:** Moorean common sense is a claim to knowledge, not an opinion poll or convention.

Examiner trap 4: Treating conceptual uncertainty as evidential uncertainty.

Repair action: Keep truth-known and analysis-known in separate columns.

Coverage mapping: C02.

PYQ linkage: 2019 Q3(c); 2021 Q3(a); 2024 Q1(c).

MCQ 5

The paradox of analysis arises because a correct analysis appears:

A. either empirically verified, or metaphysically meaningless B. either identical and uninformative, or informative and therefore not identical C. either a logically proper name, or an incomplete symbol D. either a tautology, or a contradiction in logical space

Answer: B.

Option explanations: - **A:** Verification and metaphysical meaning belong to a later positivist debate, not this paradox. - **B:** Correct: sameness threatens informativeness, while difference threatens correctness. - **C:** Proper names and incomplete symbols are Russellian categories, not the two horns of Moore's paradox. - **D:** Tautology and contradiction are Tractarian limiting cases, not analyses of synonymy.

Examiner trap 5: Substituting a later philosophy-of-language distinction.

Repair action: Use analysandum/analysans and state both horns.

Coverage mapping: C02.

PYQ linkage: 2019 Q3(c); 2024 Q1(c).

MCQ 6

Moore's truisms are best understood as:

A. claims certified solely by widespread public assent and established philosophical convention over time B. analytic truths whose denial is formally self-contradictory in every possible case C. ordinary world-propositions claimed to be known more certainly than sceptical premises D. scientific hypotheses confirmed only by repeated observation and induction

Answer: C.

Option explanations: - **A:** Moore does not infer truth from popularity or sociological consensus. - **B:** Many truisms are contingent world-claims, not analytic truths. - **C:** Correct: comparative certainty, not polling, gives the truisms their dialectical role. - **D:** Their status is not reduced to inductive scientific confirmation.

Examiner trap 6: Equating common sense with common belief.

Repair action: Define common sense by epistemic status and examples.

Coverage mapping: C02.

PYQ linkage: 2019 Q3(c); 2021 Q3(a); 2024 Q1(c).

MCQ 7

Moore's central reply to scepticism is a burden reversal because:

A. he derives the external world from premises accepted by every radical sceptic
B. he shows that dreaming is logically impossible whenever hands are visible
C. he replaces perceptual knowledge with knowledge of private sense-data
D. he argues that no sceptical premise is more certain than the truism it denies

Answer: D.

Option explanations: - **A:** The radical sceptic contests Moore's premises, so they are not neutral common ground. - **B:** The hands argument does not establish the logical impossibility of dreaming. - **C:** Moore defends ordinary external-world claims rather than retreating to private data. - **D:** Correct: Moore compares certainties and refuses to surrender the better-known proposition.

Examiner trap 7: Mistaking burden reversal for a sceptic-neutral deduction.

Repair action: Ask which premise Moore says is better known.

Coverage mapping: C02.

PYQ linkage: 2021 Q3(a); 2024 Q1(c); 2026 Q1(e).

MCQ 8

In Moore's hands proof, which list gives his three conditions for a rigorous proof?

A. the premise is probable, the conclusion is useful, and the sceptic accepts both
B. the premise is analytic, the inference is inductive, and the conclusion is certain
C. the premise differs from the conclusion, is known, and entails the conclusion
D. the premise is private, the gesture is public, and the result is verifiable

Answer: C.

Option explanations: - **A:** Moore requires knowledge and entailment, not mere probability, usefulness or sceptical consent. - **B:** The hands premises are contingent, and the inference is not an induction. - **C:** Correct: difference, knowledge and entailment are Moore's explicit three conditions. - **D:** Privacy, publicity and verification are not Moore's stated proof conditions.

Examiner trap 8: Narrating the gesture while omitting the proof criteria.

Repair action: Write the three conditions before evaluating scepticism.

Coverage mapping: C03.

PYQ linkage: 2026 Q1(e).

MCQ 9

What follows immediately from Moore's two-hand illustration?

A. at least two material objects exist, so an external world exists B. all perceptual beliefs are infallible in every possible circumstance C. the radical sceptic accepts that Moore knows the premises D. realism has been derived without any appeal to ordinary knowledge

Answer: A.

Option explanations: - **A:** Correct: hands count as things encountered in space, giving the required existential conclusion. - **B:** Moore does not generalise from this proof to universal perceptual infallibility. - **C:** The radical sceptic disputes precisely the claimed knowledge of the premises. - **D:** The argument explicitly relies on Moore's ordinary perceptual knowledge.

Examiner trap 9: Inflating a limited existential conclusion into infallibilism.

Repair action: State only two objects and an external world.

Coverage mapping: C03.

PYQ linkage: 2026 Q1(e).

MCQ 10

The strongest standard objection to Moore's proof is that it:

A. begs the question by asserting knowledge where the sceptic challenges entitlement B. uses a conclusion identical with its premise, making the proof formally circular throughout C. fails because a hand is not an object located in space at all D. depends upon Berkeley's claim that existence is perception

Answer: A.

Option explanations: - **A:** Correct: the dispute concerns whether Moore may claim to know 'here is a hand.' - **B:** The premise and conclusion differ, satisfying Moore's first condition. - **C:** Moore treats hands precisely as external things encountered in space. - **D:** The proof opposes scepticism and does not presuppose Berkeleyan idealism.

Examiner trap 10: Calling the inference invalid instead of challenging premise-knowledge.

Repair action: Separate validity from dialectical sufficiency.

Coverage mapping: C03.

PYQ linkage: 2021 Q3(a); 2026 Q1(e).

MCQ 11

A defensible verdict on Moore's proof is that it:

A. is invalid because external objects cannot include parts of one's body B. refutes every possible sceptical hypothesis by formal contradiction C. proves the complete metaphysics of mind-independent material substance D. is valid if the premises are known but may not persuade a radical sceptic

Answer: D.

Option explanations: - **A:** Hands are Moore's chosen external objects; bodily location does not invalidate the inference. - **B:** Dream and deception hypotheses are not formally contradicted by the gesture alone. - **C:** The proof establishes external objects, not a complete theory of material substance. - **D:** Correct: the conditional validity and limited anti-sceptical force must be distinguished.

Examiner trap 11: Demanding either total victory or total failure.

Repair action: Give a graded validity-versus-persuasion judgement.

Coverage mapping: C03.

PYQ linkage: 2026 Q1(e).

MCQ 12

Moore's *Refutation of Idealism* directly targets:

A. Berkeley's equation *esse est percipi* B. Hegel's claim that the rational is actual C. Russell's theory of negative facts D. Wittgenstein's distinction between saying and showing

Answer: A.

Option explanations: - **A:** Correct: the target is the identification of being with being perceived. - **B:** Moore's 1903 paper does not directly refute Hegel's Absolute Idealism. - **C:** Negative facts are a Russellian issue within logical atomism. - **D:** Saying/showing belongs to the later *Tractatus* project.

Examiner trap 12: Expanding the target from one idealist argument to all idealism.

Repair action: Name *esse est percipi* and keep the conclusion bounded.

Coverage mapping: C04.

PYQ linkage: 2020 Q2(b); 2025 Q3(c).

MCQ 13

In Moore's blue/green example, what remains common and what varies?

A. the object remains common while consciousness varies with each colour B. both consciousness and object remain numerically identical C. consciousness remains common while blue and green are distinct objects D. neither act nor object can be distinguished within sensation

Answer: C.

Option explanations: - **A:** Moore argues the reverse: consciousness is common and the presented qualities differ. - **B:** Numerical identity would erase the very blue/green difference Moore uses. - **C:** Correct: this contrast grounds the act/object distinction. - **D:** The argument claims that analysis can and must distinguish act from object.

Examiner trap 13: Reversing the constant and variable terms.

Repair action: Draw ACT = common; OBJECT = blue/green.

Coverage mapping: C04.

PYQ linkage: 2020 Q2(b); 2025 Q3(c).

MCQ 14

Calling consciousness 'diaphanous' means that:

A. awareness is transparent and attention passes through it to the object
B. awareness is a coloured mental item located beside the presented sensible quality
C. consciousness is identical with every object that it presents
D. introspection supplies a complete description of awareness itself

Answer: A.

Option explanations: - **A:** Correct: transparency explains why the act is overlooked while the object is attended to. - **B:** Moore distinguishes the act from coloured objects rather than locating it beside them. - **C:** Diaphanousness explains conflation; it does not assert identity. - **D:** The thesis stresses how hard awareness is to isolate, not introspective completeness.

Examiner trap 14: Taking transparency as identity or complete access.

Repair action: Explain transparency as the source of the idealist mistake.

Coverage mapping: C04.

PYQ linkage: 2020 Q2(b); 2025 Q3(c).

MCQ 15

What is the exact force of Moore's act/object distinction?

A. it proves that every object continues to exist when wholly unperceived
B. it demonstrates that consciousness is a physical relation among material objects in every possible case
C. it establishes that Hegelian Absolute Idealism is internally contradictory
D. it shows awareness and object are non-identical, blocking a simple definition of being as perceived

Answer: D.

Option explanations: - **A:** Mind-independent persistence needs a further argument beyond non-identity. - **B:** Moore does not reduce consciousness to a physical relation. - **C:** The paper's Berkeleyan target does not encompass Hegel's system. - **D:** Correct: the distinction defeats the identity claim on which the

targeted argument depends.

Examiner trap 15: Moving illicitly from non-identity to full realism.

Repair action: Conclude 'argument blocked,' not 'realism proved.'

Coverage mapping: C04.

PYQ linkage: 2020 Q2(b); 2025 Q3(c).

MCQ 16

Russell calls his atoms logical rather than physical because they are:

A. microscopic particles discovered by the final science of matter
B. the last residues reached through analysis of propositional structure
C. private images whose size cannot be measured physically
D. objects defined by the verification principle of the Vienna Circle

Answer: B.

Option explanations: - **A:** Physical particles are not what Russell means by logical simplicity. - **B:** Correct: atomicity concerns analytical residue and logical independence. - **C:** Sense-data may figure in Russell's phase, but atoms are not defined as images or by size. - **D:** Verificationism is a later Logical Positivist doctrine.

Examiner trap 16: Reading 'atomic' as spatially tiny.

Repair action: Tie atoms to logical analysis and proposition/fact structure.

Coverage mapping: C05.

PYQ linkage: 2020 Q2(c); 2022 Q1(b).

MCQ 17

An atomic fact in Russell's 1918 account is:

A. a sentence made true solely by its grammatical construction and logical syntax
B. a physical object containing no smaller material components
C. a particular exemplifying a quality or particulars standing in a relation
D. a logical connective joining two independent propositions

Answer: C.

Option explanations: - **A:** Sentences are truth-bearers; facts are worldly truth-makers. - **B:** Physical indivisibility is irrelevant to Russell's logical use of atomicity. - **C:** Correct: an atomic fact can contain particulars and universals without containing another fact. - **D:** A connective forms a molecular proposition and does not name an atomic fact.

Examiner trap 17: Confusing facts, sentences and physical atoms.

Repair action: Use particular-quality or relational examples.

Coverage mapping: C05.

PYQ linkage: 2020 Q2(c).

MCQ 18

In Russell's atomism, the relation between atomic and molecular propositions is that:

A. atomic propositions are abbreviations for molecular propositions
B. both kinds are logically proper names of complex objects
C. molecular propositions alone correspond directly to atomic facts
D. molecular propositions are truth-functions of atomic propositions

Answer: D.

Option explanations: - **A:** Analysis runs toward atomic propositions, not the reverse. - **B:** Propositions are not logically proper names, and connectives name no objects. - **C:** Atomic propositions, not molecular ones alone, correspond directly to atomic facts. - **D:** Correct: molecular truth-values depend on atomic components and logical operations.

Examiner trap 18: Treating logical connectives as names of extra facts.

Repair action: Remember no separate 'and'-fact is required.

Coverage mapping: C05.

PYQ linkage: 2020 Q2(c); 2022 Q1(b).

MCQ 19

Russell's isomorphism thesis claims that a true atomic proposition:

A. shares logical structure with its fact: names and arrangement correspond
B. resembles its fact visually in the manner of a photograph
C. is analytically true regardless of which possible state of affairs obtains in reality
D. contains the fact itself as one of its linguistic constituents

Answer: A.

Option explanations: - **A:** Correct: correspondence operates through mapped constituents and arrangement. - **B:** The resemblance is structural, not necessarily visual or psychological. - **C:** Atomic propositions are contingent, unlike analytic truths or tautologies. - **D:** A proposition represents a fact; it does not literally contain the worldly fact.

Examiner trap 19: Psychologising or pictorialising structural correspondence.

Repair action: Write names↔objects and arrangement↔arrangement.

Coverage mapping: C05.

PYQ linkage: 2020 Q2(c); 2022 Q3(c).

MCQ 20

Why did Russell accept negative facts, despite their ontological cost?

A. to treat negation as a physical object in the world B. to supply truth-makers for true negative propositions C. to copy the *Tractatus* account of logical constants D. to eliminate qualities and relations from atomic facts

Answer: B.

Option explanations: - **A:** Russell does not turn 'not' into a physical object. - **B:** Correct: a true claim such as 'Socrates is not alive' appears to require a negative truth-ground. - **C:** Early Wittgenstein avoids adding logical constants as objects and handles non-obtaining possibilities differently. - **D:** Negative facts supplement rather than eliminate qualities and relations.

Examiner trap 20: Attributing Wittgenstein's treatment of negation to Russell.

Repair action: Connect negative facts to truth-making, then note the cost.

Coverage mapping: C05.

PYQ linkage: 2020 Q2(c).

MCQ 21

A definite description is an incomplete symbol because it:

A. has a hidden referent that cannot be known by acquaintance B. contributes only in a complete proposition and disappears on analysis C. is an ordinary name whose reference is fixed by causal history D. forms a meaningless fragment whenever its object does not exist

Answer: B.

Option explanations: - **A:** Russell's analysis removes the need for a hidden referent. - **B:** Correct: contextual definition replaces isolated denotation. - **C:** Causal-historical reference and rigid designation belong to later criticism. - **D:** Empty descriptions can occur in meaningful false sentences.

Examiner trap 21: Equating incomplete with meaningless.

Repair action: Apply the disappearance-on-analysis test.

Coverage mapping: C06.

PYQ linkage: 2018 Q4(c); 2023 Q4(b); 2024 Q3(a).

MCQ 22

Russell's analysis of 'The F is G' contains:

A. direct acquaintance, remembered presentations and introspected mental events B. Fregean sense and reference together with Strawson's presupposition account C. simples, possible combinations and their logical coordinates D. an existence claim, a uniqueness condition and attribution of G

Answer: D.

Option explanations: - **A:** These are modes or objects of acquaintance, not description clauses. - **B:** Sense/reference is Fregean and presupposition is Strawson's rival. - **C:** These recast Tractarian ontology rather than Russell's three-conjunct analysis. - **D:** Correct: at least one F exists, at most one F exists, and that F is G.

Examiner trap 22: Giving a verbal paraphrase without the three logical clauses.

Repair action: Always enumerate existence–uniqueness–predication.

Coverage mapping: C06.

PYQ linkage: 2018 Q4(c); 2023 Q4(b); 2025 Q1(d).

MCQ 23

On Russell's analysis, 'The present King of France is bald' is:

A. false because the required existence conjunct has no satisfier in the world B. meaningless because its grammatical subject lacks a bearer C. neither true nor false because Russell treats existence as presupposed in ordinary use D. true on the condition that baldness is understood negatively

Answer: A.

Option explanations: - **A:** Correct: no present King satisfies the existence requirement. - **B:** Russell preserves meaningfulness through quantificational analysis. - **C:** Neither true nor false is Strawson's presupposition view, not Russell's. - **D:** Changing the predicate does not repair the failed existence conjunct.

Examiner trap 23: Attributing Strawson's verdict to Russell.

Repair action: Write false, not meaningless; then mention Strawson separately.

Coverage mapping: C06.

PYQ linkage: 2023 Q4(b).

MCQ 24

The sentence 'The golden mountain is very high' commits Russell to:

A. one subsisting but non-existent golden mountain B. no golden mountain, because the analysed existence clause is false C. a logically proper name whose bearer is available in sensation D. a truth-value gap generated by failed presupposition on Russell's view

Answer: B.

Option explanations: - **A:** This is the Meinongian ontology Russell seeks to avoid. - **B:** Correct: the sentence is meaningful and false without a corresponding entity. - **C:** The phrase is a description, not a demonstrative for present sense-data. - **D:** Truth-value gap is Strawson's later rival analysis.

Examiner trap 24: Thinking meaningful discourse requires a denoted object.

Repair action: Expand the sentence and inspect the existence conjunct.

Coverage mapping: C06.

PYQ linkage: 2025 Q1(d).

MCQ 25

The primary/secondary occurrence distinction is needed chiefly to handle:

A. the scope of descriptions relative to negation B. the difference between physical and logical atoms C. the contrast between awareness and its object D. the hierarchy between object-language and metalanguage

Answer: A.

Option explanations: - **A:** Correct: wide and narrow scope yield different readings of negated description sentences. - **B:** Logical versus physical atomicity concerns analysis, not quantifier scope. - **C:** Act/object is Moore's anti-idealist distinction. - **D:** Language hierarchy is Russell's proposed answer to a Tractarian limit.

Examiner trap 25: Treating all negated description sentences as one logical form.

Repair action: Mark whether negation covers the whole existential analysis.

Coverage mapping: C06.

PYQ linkage: 2023 Q4(b).

MCQ 26

Strawson's central challenge to Russell is that ordinary use of an empty description:

A. asserts existence as part of a false conjunction in every ordinary conversational use B. presupposes existence, so failed presupposition may block truth-value C. requires a Meinongian object to preserve meaningfulness D. becomes a tautology once logical form is displayed in the completed analysis

Answer: B.

Option explanations: - **A:** This restates Russell's view rather than Strawson's objection. - **B:** Correct: Strawson shifts from asserted existence to pragmatic presupposition. - **C:** Strawson does not revive Meinong's subsisting objects. - **D:** Failed reference does not turn the sentence into a tautology.

Examiner trap 26: Calling Strawson a refutation rather than a rival account of use.

Repair action: Contrast assertion analysis with presupposition.

Coverage mapping: C06.

PYQ linkage: 2023 Q4(b).

MCQ 27

How does description theory support, but not entail, logical atomism?

A. it proves that all ultimate atoms must be private sense-data and entirely excludes universals from the final ontology
B. it removes apparent constituents and leaves candidates for simples without proving the final inventory
C. it converts each molecular proposition into a corresponding physical atom after analysis
D. it establishes logical independence merely from the contextual meaning of description phrases

Answer: B.

Option explanations: - **A:** Russell's phase includes universals, and description theory does not prove sense-data. - **B:** Correct: contextual elimination is a method; termination and the nature of simples require added commitments. - **C:** Logical analysis does not transform propositions into physical objects. - **D:** Independence is an atomist thesis, not a semantic consequence of the word 'description'.

Examiner trap 27: Turning a methodological route into a deductive proof.

Repair action: Use 'supports' or 'makes reachable,' not 'entails.'

Coverage mapping: C06.

PYQ linkage: 2018 Q4(c); 2024 Q3(a).

MCQ 28

Russell's Principle of Acquaintance states that:

A. all knowledge concerns objects reached only by description
B. ordinary proper names guarantee direct presentation of their bearers
C. every understood proposition is composed of constituents with which we are acquainted
D. material objects are immediately given as complete wholes

Answer: C.

Option explanations: - **A:** Russell distinguishes indirect description from direct acquaintance. - **B:** Ordinary names are usually disguised descriptions, not guaranteed direct names. - **C:** Correct: description extends knowledge, but intelligibility must bottom out in acquainted constituents. - **D:** Material objects are reconstructed from sense-data rather than given as complete wholes.

Examiner trap 28: Thinking acquaintance and description are rival exhaustive theories.

Repair action: Use acquaintance as the basis enabling description.

Coverage mapping: C07.

PYQ linkage: 2018 Q4(c); 2023 Q4(b).

MCQ 29

In Russell's Bismarck example, a person who never met Bismarck knows him:

A. by description, such as the first Chancellor of the German Empire B. by direct acquaintance with Bismarck's own sense-data C. through a logically proper demonstrative fixed in present experience D. not at all, because indirect knowledge is impossible

Answer: A.

Option explanations: - **A:** Correct: descriptive knowledge reaches beyond what is immediately presented. - **B:** Only Bismarck himself or an observer had relevant direct acquaintance. - **C:** A demonstrative like 'this' applies to present acquaintance, not a remote historical person. - **D:** Russell explicitly uses description to explain genuine indirect knowledge.

Examiner trap 29: Treating indirect knowledge as no knowledge.

Repair action: Trace the Bismarck series from direct to purely descriptive.

Coverage mapping: C07.

PYQ linkage: 2018 Q4(c); 2023 Q4(b).

MCQ 30

For Russell, ordinary proper names such as 'Bismarck' are generally:

A. logically proper names whose bearers are guaranteed by syntax B. incomplete symbols whose occurrence makes every containing sentence meaningless as a whole C. disguised descriptions, unlike demonstratives tied to present acquaintance D. names of universals rather than of particular persons at all

Answer: C.

Option explanations: - **A:** Syntax does not guarantee direct reference to an acquainted bearer. - **B:** Descriptions are incomplete symbols, but their sentences remain meaningful. - **C:** Correct: ordinary names abbreviate descriptive content; 'this/that' are the strict candidates. - **D:** Bismarck is treated as a particular known descriptively, not a universal.

Examiner trap 30: Calling every grammatical name logically proper.

Repair action: Ask whether the bearer is directly presented.

Coverage mapping: C07.

PYQ linkage: 2018 Q4(c); 2022 Q1(b).

MCQ 31

The main pressure on Russell's acquaintance base is that it:

A. contains too many publicly accessible material objects to serve as a minimal logical foundation
B. makes every ordinary name a rigid designator through immediate presentation of its bearer
C. becomes too thin and near-solipsistic when restricted to present sense-data
D. eliminates the distinction between particulars and universals

Answer: C.

Option explanations: - **A:** Russell's problem is scarcity of directly given public objects, not excess. - **B:** Rigid designation is a later Kripkean criticism of descriptivism. - **C:** Correct: a secure private base struggles to recover other minds and a public world. - **D:** Russell includes both acquainted particulars and universals in the relevant phase.

Examiner trap 31: Ignoring the epistemic cost of certainty.

Repair action: Pair foundational security with the solipsism/other-minds worry.

Coverage mapping: C07.

PYQ linkage: 2018 Q4(c); 2024 Q3(a).

MCQ 32

Russell's supreme maxim recommends that philosophers:

A. replace every proposition with a verification report from natural science
B. substitute constructions from known entities for inferences to unknown entities where possible
C. infer hidden material substances whenever sense-data appear orderly
D. treat all constructions as useful fictions lacking truth conditions

Answer: B.

Option explanations: - **A:** Verification reports belong to a later positivist programme. - **B:** Correct: the maxim expresses ontological economy and methodological caution. - **C:** Russell's maxim reverses this move by avoiding unnecessary inferred entities. - **D:** Logical constructions allow true statements without adding a separate ontological object.

Examiner trap 32: Reducing construction to fiction or verificationism.

Repair action: Quote the maxim and explain 'where possible.'

Coverage mapping: C08.

PYQ linkage: 2018 Q4(c); 2024 Q3(a).

MCQ 33

A Russellian material object as a logical construction is best described as:

A. a hidden substance inferred behind all possible appearances B. a single physical atom that causes every private sensation C. an orderly system of actual and possible sense-data D. a metaphysical object shown but incapable of being said

Answer: C.

Option explanations: - **A:** The maxim substitutes constructions for this kind of inference. - **B:** Logical construction is not physical atomism or a single cause. - **C:** Correct: the object is reconstructed from structured sensory data rather than added behind them. - **D:** Shown/not said is a Tractarian distinction, not Russell's construction account.

Examiner trap 33: Calling a construction an inferred hidden thing.

Repair action: Use system-of-sense-data plus incomplete-symbol language.

Coverage mapping: C08.

PYQ linkage: 2018 Q4(c); 2024 Q3(a).

MCQ 34

The best qualified assessment of logical constructions is that they:

A. eliminate every inference and establish a complete public ontology without residual assumptions B. are identical with Wittgenstein's unspecified simple objects C. depend on Strawson's presupposition theory of ordinary reference D. secure economy but face private-data, other-minds and residual-inference problems

Answer: D.

Option explanations: - **A:** Russell cannot remove all inference or fully recover publicity from private data. - **B:** Wittgenstein's objects are not systems constructed from sense-data. - **C:** Strawson criticises description theory and does not ground Russell's constructions. - **D:** Correct: the maxim is powerful but functions partly as a regulative ideal.

Examiner trap 34: Presenting the supreme maxim as a completed reduction.

Repair action: State both economy and the residual epistemic cost.

Coverage mapping: C08.

PYQ linkage: 2018 Q4(c); 2024 Q3(a).

MCQ 35

The opening ontological claim of the *Tractatus* is that:

A. facts collectively constitute the world rather than a mere inventory of things B. the world consists exclusively of private sense-data immediately presented to a solitary knower C. the world is whatever common sense certifies with certainty D. the world is a hierarchy of object-languages and metalanguages

Answer: A.

Option explanations: - **A:** Correct: facts, understood through obtaining states of affairs, compose the world. - **B:** Private sense-data belong to Russell's epistemological phase, not Wittgenstein's opening ontology. - **C:** Common-sense certification is Moore's method. - **D:** The hierarchy is Russell's proposed response, not the world's ontology.

Examiner trap 35: Replacing facts with a heap of objects.

Repair action: Begin 1.1 before explaining picturing.

Coverage mapping: C09.

PYQ linkage: 2022 Q3(c); 2026 Q4(a).

MCQ 36

In the *Tractatus*, a state of affairs is:

A. a complete list of all things regardless of combination B. a mental image produced by a perceiving subject C. a molecular proposition built from logical constants D. a combination of objects within logical space

Answer: D.

Option explanations: - **A:** A mere inventory misses the combinatorial structure central to facts. - **B:** The picture theory is logical rather than psychological. - **C:** A proposition represents a state of affairs; it is not identical with it. - **D:** Correct: facts obtain when possible combinations of objects are realised.

Examiner trap 36: Confusing objects with their possible combinations.

Repair action: Use objects + combination = state of affairs.

Coverage mapping: C09.

PYQ linkage: 2022 Q3(c).

MCQ 37

According to picture theory, an elementary proposition represents because:

A. its words visually resemble the objects named in every language B. its names and their arrangement map objects and their possible arrangement C. it has been empirically verified by a competent observer D. its grammatical subject denotes an independently existing substance

Answer: B.

Option explanations: - **A:** Translation shows that picturing cannot require visual resemblance. - **B:** Correct: the mapping relation and shared structure make picturing possible. - **C:** Verification is not Wittgenstein's criterion of propositional sense. - **D:** Surface subject-predicate grammar need not reveal logical form.

Examiner trap 37: Treating a logical picture as a mental or visual image.

Repair action: Write names ↔ objects and arrangement ↔ arrangement.

Coverage mapping: C09.

PYQ linkage: 2022 Q3(c).

MCQ 38

Pictorial form differs from logical form because:

A. logical form varies with colour or spatial medium, while pictorial form never varies B. pictorial form is grammatical syntax, while logical form is a private mental image C. pictorial form may vary with a representational medium, while logical form is common to every picture and reality D. logical form is one more empirical feature that a proposition can state about itself

Answer: C.

Option explanations: - **A:** This reverses the medium-specific and universal roles. - **B:** Neither form is a private image, and pictorial form is not mere grammar. - **C:** Correct: logical form is the universal representational condition within varying pictorial forms. - **D:** A picture cannot depict its own logical form; it displays it.

Examiner trap 38: Reversing genus and medium-specific form.

Repair action: Use pictorial = medium-specific; logical = common condition.

Coverage mapping: C09.

PYQ linkage: 2022 Q3(c); 2026 Q4(a).

MCQ 39

Bipolarity requires a genuine factual proposition to be:

A. true in every possible state of affairs B. capable of truth and capable of falsity C. false in every possible state of affairs D. meaningful only after empirical confirmation

Answer: B.

Option explanations: - **A:** Truth in every possibility characterises tautology, which says nothing factual. - **B:** Correct: a proposition says something by selecting and excluding possibilities. - **C:** Falsity in every possibility characterises contradiction. - **D:** Sense precedes actual verification; the proposition must depict a possible situation.

Examiner trap 39: Equating meaningfulness with actual verification.

Repair action: Ask whether both truth-values remain possible.

Coverage mapping: C09.

PYQ linkage: 2021 Q4(c); 2022 Q3(c).

MCQ 40

The logical independence of elementary propositions is pressured by:

A. the colour-exclusion case, where one colour attribution rules out another
B. Moore's two-hand proof, because one premise entails an external-world conclusion
C. Strawson's claim that descriptions carry presuppositions
D. Russell's distinction between acquaintance and description

Answer: A.

Option explanations: - **A:** Correct: 'this is red' and 'this is green' cannot both hold at the same place and time. - **B:** Moore's entailment concerns external objects, not elementary independence. - **C:** Presupposition theory challenges descriptions rather than Tractarian colour logic. - **D:** Acquaintance is Russell's epistemology, not this internal pressure.

Examiner trap 40: Importing later language-games instead of an internal early problem.

Repair action: Use colour exclusion only as a bounded transition pressure.

Coverage mapping: C09.

PYQ linkage: 2022 Q3(c); later boundary.

MCQ 41

For early Wittgenstein, molecular propositions are generated from elementary propositions by:

A. inductive generalisation from repeatedly observed atomic objects
B. the synthesis of a grammatical subject with a metaphysical substance
C. a hierarchy in which every proposition moves to a higher language
D. truth-functional operations expressed in the general form of proposition

Answer: D.

Option explanations: - **A:** Induction is not the compositional basis of molecular propositions. - **B:** Subject-substance grammar is exactly the kind of surface form analysis resists. - **C:** Language hierarchy addresses metalinguistic structure, not ordinary truth-function construction. - **D:** Correct: all propositions are truth-functions of elementary propositions.

Examiner trap 41: Confusing truth-functional generation with hierarchy.

Repair action: Connect elementary propositions to the general form.

Coverage mapping: C10.

PYQ linkage: 2021 Q4(c); 2026 Q4(a).

MCQ 42

Let $N(\xi)$ be generalised joint negation over any finite set of propositions: it denies every member of ξ . Thus $N(p, q) = \neg p \wedge \neg q$ and $\neg p = N(p)$. Which formula expresses $p \vee q$?

A. $N(p, q)$ B. $N(N(p), N(q))$ C. $N(N(p, q))$ D. $N(N(N(p, q)))$

Answer: C.

Option explanations: - **A:** $N(p, q)$ is the joint negation itself, not disjunction. - **B:** Since $N(p) = \neg p$ and $N(q) = \neg q$, this is $\neg\neg p \wedge \neg\neg q$, hence $p \wedge q$, not disjunction. - **C:** Correct: negating the joint denial yields $p \vee q$ by De Morgan equivalence. - **D:** An additional negation returns to the wrong polarity rather than $p \vee q$.

Examiner trap 42: Guessing by visual complexity.

Repair action: Translate N into words before simplifying.

Coverage mapping: C10.

PYQ linkage: Technical support for 2021 Q4(c).

MCQ 43

A tautology in the *Tractatus* is classified as:

A. *sinnlos*: well-formed but without factual content B. *unsinnig*: an ill-formed metaphysical pseudo-proposition C. a false elementary proposition excluded by reality D. an ethical truth that can only be shown

Answer: A.

Option explanations: - **A:** Correct: tautologies show logical scaffolding but say nothing about how the world stands. - **B:** *Unsinnig* applies to attempts that violate the conditions of sense. - **C:** Contradiction is false in every possibility; a tautology is true in every possibility. - **D:** Ethics lies beyond factual saying and is not identical with logical tautology.

Examiner trap 43: Translating both German terms as the same kind of nonsense.

Repair action: Keep *sinnlos* = empty but legitimate; *unsinnig* = pseudo-proposition.

Coverage mapping: C10.

PYQ linkage: 2021 Q4(c).

MCQ 44

Which contrast is exact?

A. tautology is contingently true whereas contradiction is contingently false in actual logical space B. tautology is shown, while contradiction is an empirical proposition C. both are unsinnig because neither can be verified by observation D. tautology and contradiction delimit logical space without depicting a contingent fact

Answer: D.

Option explanations: - **A:** The two are necessary limiting cases, not contingent propositions. - **B:** Contradiction is not empirical, and the shown/sayable contrast is misstated. - **C:** Their status is sinnlos, and verificationism is not the governing criterion. - **D:** Correct: both are well-formed yet lack bipolar factual content.

Examiner trap 44: Calling contradiction ordinary falsehood or both metaphysical nonsense.

Repair action: Place them at opposite limits of truth conditions.

Coverage mapping: C10.

PYQ linkage: 2021 Q4(c).

MCQ 45

The distinction between *sinnlos* and *unsinnig* is best stated as:

A. the former is false language, the latter true but unverifiable language B. the former belongs to Moore, the latter belongs to Russell C. the former is empty yet well-formed logic, the latter violates the conditions of sense D. the former can be pictured, the latter is a molecular truth-function

Answer: C.

Option explanations: - **A:** Neither term simply divides false from true or unverifiable discourse. - **B:** Both are Tractarian classifications rather than owner labels for Moore and Russell. - **C:** Correct: tautologies/contradictions are sinnlos; metaphysical pseudo-propositions are unsinnig. - **D:** Sinnlos propositions do not picture contingent facts, and unsinnig items are not truth-functions.

Examiner trap 45: Using the terms as loose synonyms.

Repair action: Anchor each term to its canonical example.

Coverage mapping: C10.

PYQ linkage: 2018 Q3(c); 2021 Q4(c).

MCQ 46

In the saying/showing distinction, propositions can say:

A. the logical form shared by language and reality B. the absolute value that makes ethical action good C. contingent states of affairs capable of truth or falsity D. the metaphysical subject as an object located within the empirical world

Answer: C.

Option explanations: - **A:** Logical form is displayed by meaningful propositions but cannot itself be stated as a fact. - **B:** Ethics and value are transcendental rather than factual propositions. - **C:** Correct: factual propositions picture possible situations in logical space. - **D:** The metaphysical self is a limit of the world, not one object among others.

Examiner trap 46: Assuming whatever matters most must be factually sayable.

Repair action: Separate contingent fact from conditions and value.

Coverage mapping: C11.

PYQ linkage: 2018 Q3(c); 2021 Q4(c); 2026 Q4(a).

MCQ 47

What belongs on the 'shown, not said' side for early Wittgenstein?

A. scientific hypotheses awaiting empirical confirmation B. ordinary descriptions whose apparent subject currently lacks a bearer C. Moorean truisms and Russellian sense-data treated as factual claims D. representational form together with value, beauty and the mystical

Answer: D.

Option explanations: - **A:** Scientific hypotheses are sayable if they picture possible facts. - **B:** Descriptions are analysed within language rather than assigned to the mystical. - **C:** Moore's and Russell's doctrines do not form Wittgenstein's showing inventory. - **D:** Correct: these exceed contingent factual representation without being classified as ordinary falsehoods.

Examiner trap 47: Calling the unsayable empirically false or merely unknown.

Repair action: List form, value, self and mystical.

Coverage mapping: C11.

PYQ linkage: 2018 Q3(c); 2021 Q4(c).

MCQ 48

The ladder metaphor at *Tractatus* 6.54 means that:

A. higher metalanguages permanently preserve every sentence of the book as fact B. the propositions become scientific hypotheses after empirical confirmation C. logical form can finally be stated from outside all possible representation D. the book's elucidations are recognised as nonsense and discarded after use

Answer: D.

Option explanations: - **A:** The hierarchy is Russell's proposal, not Wittgenstein's account of 6.54. - **B:** The book's philosophical remarks do not become empirical science. - **C:** No final outside standpoint is available within the Tractarian argument. - **D:** Correct: the reader climbs through elucidations and then throws away the ladder.

Examiner trap 48: Treating the ladder as an accidental contradiction.

Repair action: Connect 6.54 deliberately to self-application.

Coverage mapping: C11.

PYQ linkage: 2018 Q3(c); 2021 Q4(c).

MCQ 49

The standard and resolute readings disagree chiefly over whether:

A. elementary propositions can be true as well as false B. Russell's descriptions contain existence and uniqueness C. the *Tractatus* gestures at ineffable truths or offers only therapeutic nonsense D. Moore's hands satisfy three proof conditions in the final analysis

Answer: C.

Option explanations: - **A:** Both readings accept the text's bipolarity framework as the context of the dispute. - **B:** Description analysis is Russellian and irrelevant to this interpretive split. - **C:** Correct: the dispute concerns illuminating ineffability versus uncompromising therapeutic dissolution. - **D:** Moore's proof conditions do not bear on readings of 6.54.

Examiner trap 49: Presenting one contested reading as uncontested doctrine.

Repair action: Name both readings before choosing a verdict.

Coverage mapping: C11.

PYQ linkage: 2018 Q3(c); 2021 Q4(c); 2026 Q4(a).

MCQ 50

Who proposes the hierarchy of languages discussed in the 2026 question?

A. early Wittgenstein in proposition 7 B. Tarski in Wittgenstein's 1918 notebooks C. the Vienna Circle in Moore's 1939 proof D. Russell in his 1922 Introduction to the *Tractatus*

Answer: D.

Option explanations: - **A:** Proposition 7 enjoins silence and does not propose a hierarchy. - **B:** Tarski's work is later and independent, not part of Wittgenstein's notebooks. - **C:** The Vienna Circle and Moore's proof are unrelated to the proposal's authorship. - **D:** Correct: Russell suggests L1, L2, L3 and no final language.

Examiner trap 50: Attributing the proposed escape to Wittgenstein.

Repair action: Write Russell 1922 Introduction before evaluating it.

Coverage mapping: C12.

PYQ linkage: 2026 Q4(a).

MCQ 51

A hierarchy of languages most clearly succeeds in:

A. stating the logical form common to representation from a final standpoint B. giving a metalanguage for syntax or truth of a specified object-language C. making ethics and the mystical factual at a higher linguistic level D. eliminating the form of every metalanguage in a finite number of steps

Answer: B.

Option explanations: - **A:** The open hierarchy contains no final standpoint outside representation. - **B:** Correct: object-language/metalanguage separation handles local formal-semantic tasks. - **C:** Value and the mystical are not converted into facts by richer syntax. - **D:** Each metalanguage introduces another level whose own form remains at issue.

Examiner trap 51: Treating local formal success as total philosophical success.

Repair action: State what L2 can rigorously say about L1.

Coverage mapping: C12.

PYQ linkage: 2026 Q4(a).

MCQ 52

Why does the hierarchy fail as a complete answer to Wittgenstein?

A. the hierarchy contains only one language and therefore cannot distinguish levels B. Wittgenstein denies that propositions possess any logical structure C. Russell requires every higher language to be empirically verified D. each metalanguage has its own unstated form, so the limit is displaced upward

Answer: D.

Option explanations: - **A:** Russell explicitly proposes indefinitely many levels. - **B:** Wittgenstein insists on shared logical form; he denies that it can be pictured. - **C:** Empirical verification is not Russell's condition for constructing the hierarchy. - **D:** Correct: no level supplies the final external standpoint needed to state representation as such.

Examiner trap 52: Answering only with infinite regress without its philosophical significance.

Repair action: Link regress to the missing total standpoint.

Coverage mapping: C12.

PYQ linkage: 2026 Q4(a).

MCQ 53

What is the proper use of Tarski in the 2026 hierarchy answer?

A. as proof that Wittgenstein himself accepted Russell's hierarchy in 1921
B. as the source of the *Tractatus* distinction between saying and showing
C. as a Logical Positivist verification test for Moore's common-sense claims
D. as later evidence that richer metalanguages solve formal truth-definition problems

Answer: D.

Option explanations: - **A:** Wittgenstein was unpersuaded by Russell's Introduction; Tarski cannot prove his acceptance. - **B:** Saying/showing is internal to the *Tractatus*, not derived from Tarski. - **C:** Tarski's semantic work is neither verificationism nor an appraisal of Moore. - **D:** Correct: Tarski independently vindicates a limited formal distinction decades later.

Examiner trap 53: Anachronistically making Tarski Wittgenstein's own solution.

Repair action: Label Tarski later, independent and formally limited.

Coverage mapping: C12.

PYQ linkage: 2026 Q4(a).

MCQ 54

How should the later Wittgenstein be used in the hierarchy answer?

A. as a bounded comparison: he abandons the demand for one logical form rather than ascending a hierarchy
B. as evidence that the early picture theory already contained the later doctrine of language-games in developed form
C. as the primary owner of the 2026 hierarchy question because his mature work concerns language
D. as confirmation that the private-language argument supplies a final unrestricted metalanguage

Answer: A.

Option explanations: - **A:** Correct: the later shift dissolves the original framework but remains outside primary ownership. - **B:** Language-games are later and must not be retrojected into the *Tractatus*. - **C:** The 2026 part is primarily owned by Moore–Russell–Early Wittgenstein. - **D:** The private-language argument does not provide a hierarchy or final metalanguage.

Examiner trap 54: Letting later doctrine replace analysis of the early problem.

Repair action: Use one closing comparison only after answering the hierarchy.

Coverage mapping: C12.

PYQ linkage: 2026 Q4(a); later boundary.

MCQ 55

Which ownership statement is correct for adjacent material?

A. verificationism is Logical Positivism-owned, while the 2026 hierarchy issue is primarily owned here B. private-language arguments are early-Wittgenstein doctrines because both projects concern language and meaning C. the 2018 Berkeley comparison is one of this topic's sixteen direct PYQs D. Tarski's truth theory is a doctrine stated by Moore in defence of common sense

Answer: A.

Option explanations: - **A:** Correct: the boundary preserves both the hierarchy's primary owner and the next topic's verification project. - **B:** Private language belongs to later Wittgenstein despite thematic overlap. - **C:** 2018 Q3(a) is Empiricism-owned and remains only a cross-link. - **D:** Tarski is later and unrelated to Moore's commonsense method.

Examiner trap 55: Counting thematic overlap as duplicate ownership.

Repair action: Route by the question's centre of gravity and ledger.

Coverage mapping: C13.

PYQ linkage: Ownership reconciliation.

MCQ 56

Which accounting of directly owned PYQs is accurate?

A. sixteen parts from 2018–2025 plus two further cross-links in 2026 B. fourteen parts through 2026 because both new questions belong elsewhere C. fourteen parts from 2018–2025 plus two 2026 additions, totalling sixteen D. eighteen parts after counting Berkeley, private language and verificationism

Answer: C.

Option explanations: - **A:** The 2018–2025 ledger contains fourteen, not sixteen, directly owned parts. - **B:** Both 2026 Q1(e) and Q4(a) are explicitly routed to this owner. - **C:** Correct: the verified direct set is $14 + 2 = 16$. - **D:** Cross-links never inflate ownership counts; Berkeley, private language and verificationism remain

with their primary owners.

Examiner trap 56: Counting cross-links or omitting the latest paper.

Repair action: Reconcile each part against both portable ledgers.

Coverage mapping: C13.

PYQ linkage: All 16 direct parts.